George”

Then we brought in Elie Wiesel, survivor of the Holocaust and several others who were on hand for the Jewish Heritage Week Ceremony in which I was presenting Elie with the Congressional gold medal. I explained the situation to them and made some gains even if later Elie in his prepared remarks implored me not to visit the cemetery. We’ve invited Elie to accompany me on the trip. He’s said yes except that he won’t be present at the cemetery.

April 20-21 Camp David

Weather wonderful, in the 80’s—swam both days and rode on Saturday. Sunday an early return. Nancy went on to Calif. . . . just for overnight, to see a house. That comes under the heading of looking ahead. Mermie [my daughter Maureen] here for dinner.

April 26

Sen. Metzenbaum along with others . . . got a non-binding resolution passed asking Germany to let me out of the Bitburg cemetery visit. Unfortunately, some of our Republicans went along. Well, I don’t want out. I think I am doing what is morally right.

April 27

A day of reading my eyes out, briefing materials for trip. The press is still chewing on the Bitburg visit. I’ll just keep on praying.

April 28

More homework. A nice day and lunch on the Truman balcony. Called Jerry Ford to thank him for his words re Bitburg. I’m worried about Nancy. She’s uptight about the situation and nothing I can say can wind her down. I’ll pray about that too.